This will render a file named `_menu.html.erb` at that point within the view being rendered. Note the leading underscore character: partials are named with a leading underscore to distinguish them from regular views, even though they are referred to without the underscore. This holds true even when you're pulling in a partial from another folder:

```
<%= render "shared/menu" %>
```

That code will pull in the partial from `app/views/shared/_menu.html.erb`.

3.4.2 Using Partials to Simplify Views

One way to use partials is to treat them as the equivalent of subroutines: as a way to move details out of a view so that you can grasp what's going on more easily. For example, you might have a view that looked like this:

```
<%= render "shared/ad_banner" %>

<h1>Products</h1>

<p>Here are a few of our fine products:</p>
...

<%= render "shared/footer" %>
```

Here, the `_ad_banner.html.erb` and `_footer.html.erb` partials could contain content that is shared among many pages in your application. You don't need to see the details of these sections when you're concentrating on a particular page.

As you already could see from the previous sections of this guide, `yield` is a very powerful tool for cleaning up your layouts. Keep in mind that it's pure ruby, so you can use it almost everywhere. For example, we can use it to DRY form layout definition for several similar resources:

- `users/index.html.erb`

```
<%= render "shared/search_filters", search: @q do |f| %>
  <p>
    Name contains: <%= f.text_field :name_contains %>
  </p>
<% end %>
```

- `roles/index.html.erb`

```
<%= render "shared/search_filters", search: @q do |f| %>
  <p>
    Title contains: <%= f.text_field :title_contains %>
  </p>
<% end %>
```

- `shared/_search_filters.html.erb`

```
<%= form_for(@q) do |f| %>
  <h1>Search form:</h1>
  <fieldset>
    <%= yield f %>
  </fieldset>
  <p>
    <%= f.submit "Search" %>
  </p>
<% end %>
```

For content that is shared among all pages in your application, you can use partials directly from layouts.

3.4.3 Partial Layouts

A partial can use its own layout file, just as a view can use a layout. For example, you might call a partial like this:

```
<%= render partial: "link_area", layout: "graybar" %>
```